DOMESTIC AIRLINES — TRAINING

Operations Manual and Regulations

Course handbook

ICAO and EASA regulatory framework, the Operations Manual structure (OM A–D), the commander's authority and the key rules reviewed each year.

4 lessons · 2 modules · about 0.5 hours

Training material only. It does not replace the Aircraft Flight Manual, FCOM, QRH, MEL or the Domestic Airlines Operations Manual, which always take precedence.

Contents

MODULE 1 — REGULATIONS

01 The International Framework: ICAO

02 EASA Air Operations Structure

MODULE 2 — THE OPERATIONS MANUAL

03 The Operations Manual

04 Commander's Authority, Duties and Key Rules

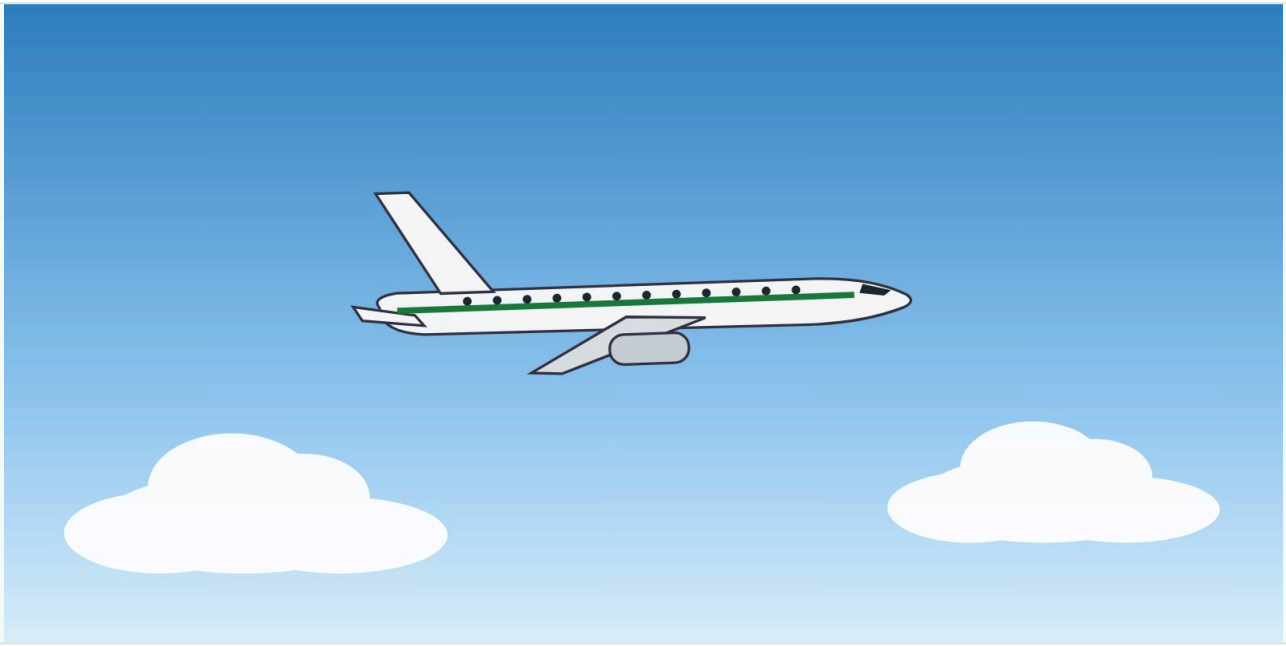
MODULE 1 · REGULATIONS

Lesson 01: The International Framework: ICAO

Lesson 1 of 4 · about 6 min

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Describe the role of ICAO and the Chicago Convention.
- Distinguish Standards, Recommended Practices and guidance material.
- Identify the ICAO Annexes most relevant to flight crews.



ICAO SARPs are the foundation of every national rule.

ICAO and the Chicago Convention

The **Convention on International Civil Aviation** (Chicago, 1944) created the International Civil Aviation Organization (ICAO). Contracting States agree to apply ICAO **Standards and Recommended Practices (SARPs)**, published in the Annexes, and to notify ICAO of any **differences** (published in the AIP).

- **Standards** — “shall”: necessary for safety or regularity; States must comply or notify a difference.
- **Recommended Practices** — “should”: desirable; States endeavour to comply.
- **PANS** (e.g. PANS-OPS Doc 8168, PANS-ATM Doc 4444) — procedures with a wider level of detail.
- **Manuals and circulars** — guidance material (e.g. Doc 9613 PBN, Doc 9574 RVSM, Doc 10011 UPRT).

Annexes most relevant to flight crew

Annex	Subject
1	Personnel licensing

2	Rules of the air
3	Meteorological service
6	Operation of aircraft (Part I: international commercial air transport — aeroplanes)
8	Airworthiness
10 / 11	Aeronautical telecommunications / Air traffic services
12, 13	Search and rescue, Accident and incident investigation
14	Aerodromes
15	Aeronautical information services
17, 18, 19	Security, Dangerous goods, Safety management

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- The Chicago Convention created ICAO; States apply SARPs or notify differences.
- Standards (“shall”), Recommended Practices (“should”), PANS and guidance manuals.
- Annex 6 Part I is the core operational Annex for commercial air transport.

KNOWLEDGE CHECK

What must a State do if it cannot comply with an ICAO Standard?

A. Nothing

B. Notify ICAO of the difference (published in the AIP)

C. Leave ICAO

D. Ask the operator to decide

Answer: B. Differences from Standards must be notified to ICAO.

MODULE 1 · REGULATIONS

Lesson 02: EASA Air Operations Structure

Lesson 2 of 4 · about 6 min

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Describe the structure of the EASA Air Operations Regulation.
- Distinguish implementing rules, AMC and GM.
- Explain how national rules relate to EASA and ICAO.



Implementing rules, AMC and GM — and national oversight.

The regulation

In Europe, the Basic Regulation (EU) 2018/1139 sets the framework, and **Regulation (EU) No 965/2012** (Air Operations) contains the detailed requirements in Annexes:

Annex	Part	Content
I	Definitions	Terms used throughout
II	Part-ARO	Requirements for authorities
III	Part-ORO	Organisation requirements: management system, manuals (MLR), flight crew (FC), cabin crew (CC), flight time limitations (FTL)
IV	Part-CAT	Commercial air transport operations: operating procedures (OP), performance (POL), instruments and equipment (IDE)
V	Part-SPA	Specific approvals: PBN (RNP AR), MNPS/HLA, RVSM, LVO, ETOPS, dangerous goods, NVIS…

- **Implementing rules** are binding.

- **AMC** (acceptable means of compliance) — one way to comply; alternatives need approval.
- **GM** (guidance material) — explanations.

National regulations

Domestic Airlines operates under the regulations and oversight of its national authority, the **DACM**, which implement the ICAO SARPs. Many national requirements follow the EASA structure, which is why our Operations Manual uses the same organisation and references. The AOC and its operations specifications define what the company is authorised to do.

COMPANY DOCUMENTS

This lesson explains the international framework. The exact company rules are in the **Domestic Airlines Operations Manual** and the national regulations of the **DACM** — always refer to the current edition.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Regulation (EU) 965/2012: Part-ARO, ORO, CAT, SPA (and others).
- Implementing rules are binding; AMC is one accepted way to comply; GM explains.
- Domestic Airlines operates under DACM regulations and its AOC / operations specifications.

KNOWLEDGE CHECK

In Regulation (EU) 965/2012, which Part covers commercial air transport operating procedures and performance?

A. Part-ARO
B. Part-CAT
C. Part-FCL
D. Part-145

Answer: B. Part-CAT covers CAT operations, performance and equipment.

MODULE 2 · THE OPERATIONS MANUAL

Lesson 03: The Operations Manual

Lesson 3 of 4 · about 6 min

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Describe the structure of the Operations Manual.
- Find information quickly in each part.
- Apply the rules on amendments and availability.



Know where to find it: OM A, B, C and D.

Structure (AMC1 ORO.MLR.100)

Part	Content
OM A — General / Basic	All non-type-related policies and procedures: organisation, responsibilities, crew composition, flight time limitations, operating procedures, dangerous goods, security, accident and incident handling, rules of the air.
OM B — Aircraft operating matters	Type-related: limitations, normal, abnormal and emergency procedures, performance, flight planning, mass and balance, loading, MEL, systems.
OM C — Route and aerodrome	Route and aerodrome instructions and information: minimum altitudes, aerodrome operating minima, communications, navigation facilities, special procedures, aerodrome categories.
OM D — Training	Training programmes and checking for all operations personnel.

Using the manual

- The Operations Manual must be **kept up to date**; the crew is responsible for using the current revision.

- Relevant parts must be **available on board** (paper or approved electronic format).
- Read and acknowledge every **amendment, temporary revision and operations notice** as the company requires.
- If the Operations Manual and the manufacturer's documents differ, follow the company's rule on precedence, normally stated in OM A.

COMPANY DOCUMENTS

This lesson explains the international framework. The exact company rules are in the **Domestic Airlines Operations Manual** and the national regulations of the **DACM** — always refer to the current edition.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- OM A general, OM B aircraft, OM C route and aerodrome, OM D training.
- Use the current revision; acknowledge amendments and notices.
- Know where to find information under time pressure.

KNOWLEDGE CHECK

Where would you normally find the aerodrome operating minima and route information?

A. OM A

B. OM B

C. OM C

D. OM D

Answer: C. OM C contains route and aerodrome information, including minima.

MODULE 2 · THE OPERATIONS MANUAL

Lesson 04: Commander's Authority, Duties and Key Rules

Lesson 4 of 4 · about 7 min

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- State the authority and responsibilities of the commander.
- Review key operational rules found in OM A.
- Recognise the documents to be carried on board.



The commander's authority — and responsibility.

The commander

- Responsible for the safety of the aircraft, persons and cargo on board, and for the conduct of the flight (ICAO Annex 6; EASA CAT.GEN.MPA.105).
- Has the authority to give all commands necessary for safety, to disembark persons or cargo that may be a hazard, and to refuse to carry inadmissible passengers or unsafe cargo.
- May deviate from rules, procedures and methods in an emergency requiring immediate decision and action, in the interest of safety — and must report it.
- Must not start the flight unless satisfied that all operational requirements are met: aircraft airworthiness, documents, crew fitness, weather and NOTAMs, fuel, mass and balance, MEL.

Key OM A subjects to review each year

- Crew composition and designation of the commander; in-flight relief;
- flight and duty time limitations and rest (ORO.FTL), fatigue reporting;
- fuel policy and in-flight fuel management;

- aerodrome selection, operating minima and the inoperative ground equipment table;
- stabilised approach and go-around policy; sterile flight deck;
- dangerous goods, security and the handling of accidents and occurrences (reporting).

Documents on board

Typical documents include: certificate of registration and certificate of airworthiness (with ARC), noise certificate, AOC copy and operations specifications, radio licence, insurance, journey log / technical log, crew licences and medical certificates, relevant parts of the Operations Manual, the AFM, the MEL, charts, the operational flight plan, mass and balance documentation, NOTAMs and weather, and the NOTOC when dangerous goods are carried. The exact list is in OM A.

COMPANY DOCUMENTS

This lesson explains the international framework. The exact company rules are in the **Domestic Airlines Operations Manual** and the national regulations of the **DACM** — always refer to the current edition.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- The commander is responsible for safety and has the authority to act for it.
- Emergency deviation from procedures is allowed in the interest of safety — and must be reported.
- Review OM A each year: FTL, fuel policy, minima, stabilised approach, DG, security, reporting.

KNOWLEDGE CHECK

In an emergency requiring immediate action, may the commander deviate from the Operations Manual?

A. Never

B. Yes, in the interest of safety, and must report it

C. Only with ATC permission

D. Only on the ground

Answer: B. Deviation is permitted in the interest of safety, followed by a report.

Training material only. It does not replace the Aircraft Flight Manual, FCOM, QRH, MEL or the Domestic Airlines Operations Manual, which always take precedence.